

GIANNA C. D'APOLITO

CURRICULUM VITAE

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EDUCATION

Arizona State University | **Population Health PhD, Health Equity Track** | August 2023 – May 2027 (Expected)

University of Pittsburgh | **Master's in Biomedical Sciences** | August 2019 - August 2020

Ohio State University | **Bachelor of Science in Neuroscience, Specialization: Behavioral/ Systems** | August 2015- May 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **PhD Candidate** | August 2023 - present

- Mixed Methods Research: Understanding Newborn Screening Refusal Rates in U.S.
 - Policy Analysis of state legislation on refusal exemptions
 - Quantitative evaluation of the first-ever nationwide state refusal rate analysis
 - Qualitative Interviewing of key state newborn screening staff
 - Qualitative and quantitative exploration of parental experience when accepting and rejecting newborn screening

Association of Public Health Laboratory-Centers for Disease Control and Prevention | **Genomic Data Intern** | October 2024 - present

- Performing a literature review of whole genome sequencing in newborn screening
- Pulling genomic data (including variant, homozygosity, variant classification, and novelty) from the screening information system using MS SQL Server
 - Cleaning and verifying genomic data in our screening information system
- Developing a universal data structure for our genomic data
- Summarizing genomic and outcomes data using Excel and SAS statistical software
- Creating data visualizations using MS Power BI

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Graduate Research Associate** | August 2023 - present

- Qualitative and quantitative health research related to Community-Based Organizations and social needs

Ohio State University Neural Stem Cell, Multiple Sclerosis (MS) Laboratory - Clinical research lab | **Research Assistant** | August 2016-May 2019

- Development of MS patient and caregiver education and outreach
- Participated in MS education days for patients and their caregivers to provide education to uninsured or underinsured patients

Ohio State University Behavioral Endocrinology and Postpartum Depression Laboratory | **Research Assistant** | September 2016-May 2017

- Implemented extensive research and behavior protocol on animals to study the neuroendocrinology involved in postpartum depression and anxiety
 - Identified neurobiological mechanism changes in the maternal rodent brain
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PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

D'Apolito G, Verdecias-Pellum N. Structural readiness of CBOs to address health-related social needs in chronic disease management programs. *BMC Health Serv Res.* 2026 Jun 25. doi: 10.1186/s12913-026-15017-9. PMID: 42351111.

Verdecias-Pellum, N., **D'Apolito, G.**, Lohr, A. M., Rascón, A. M., & Palmer, K. N. B. (2026). Expanding Diabetes Self-Management Education to Address Health-Related Social Needs: A Qualitative Feasibility Study. *International journal of environmental research and public health*, 23(1), 88. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph23010088>

D'Apolito G; Reddy, S. Effects of Advisory Committee on Heritable Disorders in Newborns and Children Termination in a Time of Public Health Mistrust. *Under Review.*

D'Apolito, G; Carter, S; Lin, C; Matteson, J; Wu, C. Understanding increasing Refusal Rates in California through Data Dashboards. *In Preparation.*

Lin, C.; **D'Apolito, G**; Matteson, J; Prediction Model of Newborn Screening Refusal Rates in California. *In Preparation.*

Thomas, N; **D'Apolito, G**; Rizwana, B; Legal Mapping of Maternal Mental Health Laws in the United States. *In Preparation.*

PRESENTATIONS

Toward Holistic Diabetes Management: Lessons on Addressing Health-Related Social Needs Within Self- Management Education Programs | American Diabetes Association | New Orleans, LA | June 2026

Development of Newborn Screening Refusal Dashboard | Association of Public Health Laboratories Annual Conference | Baltimore, MD | May 2026

Starting Strong: Newborn Screening Policy Analysis | Society for Public Health Education Annual Conference | Portland, OR | April 2026

Declining Newborn Screening | Arizona State University Health Impact Summit | Phoenix, AZ | April 2026

Born into Inequity: Understanding Risk and Mortality Among Arizona's Newborns | Arizona Health Equity Conference | Phoenix, AZ | October 2025

Impacts of Genome Supplemented Newborn Screening | Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Symposium | Providence, RI | October 2025 | *First Place Poster Award

Examining the Structural Capacity of CBOs through a Modified SWOT Analysis | Interdisciplinary Association of Population Health Science Annual Symposium | Pittsburgh, PA | September 2025

Investigating Patient Trust: Possible Increase of NBS Parent Refusals | Arizona State University Institute for Social Science Research | Phoenix, AZ | April 2025

The Potential of Genome Supplemented Newborn Screening | State of California Public Health Department -Genetic Disease Screening Program | Remote | February 2025

Using Lean Six Sigma Gemba Walk to Improve Patient Safety in Genetic Disease Screening | Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Continuous Quality Improvement Symposium | Washington, DC | April 2023

Genetic Disease Screening Laboratory Reassignment for Equitable Newborn Screening in California | State of California Genetic Disease Screening Program Conference | Sacramento, California | March 2023

Timeliness of Newborn Screening Samples in CA | Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Symposium | Tacoma, WA | August 2022

Data Analysis in CA Newborn Screening Program | State of California Genetic Disease Screening Program Symposium | Remote | February 2022

Implementation of a Sunday Courier Service for Newborn Screening Samples | Association of Public Health Laboratory Newborn Screening Symposium | Remote | October 2021

Overcoming Barriers in Progressive Multiple Sclerosis Care at The Ohio State University MS Center using the Donabedian Model and Optimal Interdisciplinary Care and Education | 2018 Denman Undergraduate Research Forum | Columbus, OH | April 2018

AWARDS

Outstanding Research Award

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | April 2026

Outstanding Mentor Award

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | April 2026

Graduate College 2025-26 Travel Award

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | April 2026

Professional Development Award

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | March 2026

Travel Award

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | February 2026

First Place Award - Poster Competition

Presented by: Association of Public Health Laboratories | October 2025

AZ Health Equity Conference Scholarship Award

Presented by: 2025 Arizona Health Equity Conference Planning Committee | September 2025

Graduate College 2025-26 Travel Award

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College | June 2025

Research Publication Award

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate Student Government | November 2025

University Graduate Fellowship Award | September 2024

Presented by: Arizona State University College of Health Solutions

Serving University Needs (SUN) Award in Teaching Assistantship | July 2024

Presented by: Arizona State University

Population Health Grant Award | January 2024

Presented by: Arizona State University Graduate College

Public Health Acknowledging My Efforts (PHAME) Award for Continuous Improvement | April 2023

Presented by: California Department of Public Health, Office of Performance and Development

Project: **Improving Delivery Efforts Across Laboratories in Genetic Disease Screening**

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of California, Los Angeles Genetics Department | **Administrative Officer & Data Analyst** | September 2023 - present

- Created lesson plans for graduate students in the UCLA Genetic Counseling Program during 2-week rotations and guided students through an individual project

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Teaching Assistant** | May-August 2024

- Teaching Assistant in Health Theory course
 - Organized and edited course content
 - Graded course assignments
- Awarded the Serving University Needs (SUN) Award in Teaching Assistantship

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Guest Lecture** | September 2025

- In-person guest lecture for the undergraduate course KIN 101- Introduction to Kinesiology
- Title: Evidence Quality and Sources to Enhance Public Trust

Arizona State University College of Health Solutions | **Guest Lecture** | October 2024

- In-person guest lecture for the graduate course POP615- Organizational Behavior and Theory
- Title: Learning and Attitudes in Organizational Behavior and Theory

Ohio State University Ear and Eye Institute | **Undergraduate Ophthalmology Internship Manager** | January 2017- May 2019

- Taught a weekly in-person professional development class to undergraduates with a focus on medical and research ethics

PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATION MEMBERSHIP

International Consortium for Newborn Sequencing (ICoNS)

Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science (IAPHS)

American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS)

Association of Public Health Laboratories (APHL)

Maternal and Child Health Translational Research Team (MCH TRT)

WORK EXPERIENCE

University of California, Los Angeles Genetics Department | **Administrative Officer & Data Analyst in Newborn Screening** | September 2023 - present

State of California Department of Public Health, Genetic Disease Screening Program | **Public Health Data Manager** | January 2022 - July 2023

State of South Carolina Dept of Health Newborn Screening Program | **Health Information Technology Coordinator** | November 2020 - December 2021

CLINICAL WORK EXPERIENCE

University of Pittsburgh Medical Center Presbyterian Emergency Department | **Physician Task Facilitator** | August 2019-March 2020

Ohio State University Wexner Medical Center | **Neurology Undergraduate Intern** | August 2016 - December 2016

SERVICE

NEJM Catalyst Innovations in Care Delivery Review | October 2025-Present

Graduate Student Government Reviewer | August 2025-Present

President, Exercise and Nutrition Science and Population Health Graduate Club | August 2023-Present

Association of Public Health Laboratories Newborn Screening Journal Club | April 2025-Present

PROFESSIONAL COURSEWORK

Global Certificate in Legal Epidemiology - Temple University – Completed Summer 2026

Lean Six Sigma Quality Improvement White Belt and Green Belt with JASP

Results-Based Accountability

DataCamp Certificates: Data Visualizations; Tableau; SQL; Python; R

REFERENCES

Available upon Request